INTERNSHIP REPORT

English Language Teaching Internship at Government College for Information Technology, Hyderabad

Student Internee: Ms. Zainab Soomro Â· BS English (Applied Linguistics), University of Sindh, Jamshoro

Supervisor: Assistant Professor Areej Ijlal Hyder Â· Principal: Prof. Nawab Ali Rahoo

1. Introduction

My internship at Government College for Information Technology (GCIT), Guru Nagar, Hyderabad, was an important component of my undergraduate studies in Applied Linguistics at the Institute of English Language and Literature, University of Sindh, Jamshoro. It provided an opportunity to connect academic knowledge with practical teaching experience in an institution that combines academic education with technological learning. The experience helped me understand classroom responsibilities, student learning needs, and the professional skills required for effective English language teaching.

I selected GCIT because I wanted to gain teaching experience in a college environment, particularly in a co-educational setting. As an aspiring English lecturer, my objectives were to apply the theories, approaches, methods, and techniques studied in Applied Linguistics, improve my lesson planning and classroom management, and develop confidence in presenting English language concepts through meaningful activities. I also aimed to learn from experienced teachers and encourage students to participate actively in their learning.

2. Organization Profile

Government College for Information Technology (GCIT), located in Guru Nagar, Hyderabad, provides intermediate-level education through its Pre-Engineering and Pre-Computer Science programmes. The institution has 25 faculty members and provides opportunities for students to develop academic knowledge and technological skills.

The college's learning environment extends beyond conventional classroom teaching. During my internship, I visited computer laboratories where students practised different courses under the guidance of their respective subject instructors. I also observed separate classes for different programmes and learned how specialised instruction supports students' academic and practical development.

The principal, Prof. Nawab Ali Rahoo, frequently visited my classes and encouraged me in my teaching responsibilities. His encouragement contributed positively to my confidence and experience as a trainee teacher. My supervisor, Assistant Professor Areej Ijlal Hyder, provided consistent guidance, identified areas where I could improve, and assigned tasks according to my developing abilities. Her constructive feedback helped me refine my teaching practices.

An important development during my internship was the publication of the college's first newsletter, Beyond the Classroom. It highlighted teaching and learning activities, training sessions, counselling, co-curricular programmes, and student development. This publication provided insight into the institution's educational activities beyond regular classroom instruction.

3. Job description/Tasks performed

My primary responsibility was to plan and deliver English lessons to a co-educational First Year class comprising more than 50 students. I prepared lesson plans, explained linguistic concepts, designed classroom activities, assessed students' understanding, and provided feedback. My main focus was to apply the theories and teaching principles studied in Applied Linguistics to practical classroom experiences.

While teaching the chapter â€œQuaid on 11th August, 1947,â€ I explained vocabulary, phrases, idioms, synonyms, and antonyms before asking students to complete multiple-choice and short-answer questions. Pair work encouraged students to discuss their answers and support one another. This reflected Vygotskyâ€™s Sociocultural Theory, as students learned through social interaction, and the learner-centred approach, as they actively participated in the activities. Approximately 85% of the students demonstrated a good understanding of the lesson.

In the lesson on parts of speech, I used the Dawn story â€œThe Word Warâ€ to explain grammatical categories and asked students to identify two examples of each part of speech from the story. Charts, sticky notes, and a boys-versus-girls activity made the lesson interactive. This reflected Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) because students completed a specific language task. The lesson also reflected Scaffolding Theory, as I explained the concepts and demonstrated examples before gradually reducing my support. Around 90% of the students correctly identified the targeted language items.

My lessons on word formation covered prefixes, suffixes, roots, and base words. I explained the concepts and used worksheets to help students identify word structures. To develop studentsâ€™ speaking

confidence, I conducted a self-introduction activity in which they organised and expressed personal information through speaking. This activity reflected Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) because students practised oral communication.

In the lesson on homophones and homonyms, I used examples, sentence-completion exercises, and a boys-versus-girls competition. Students identified homophones and homonyms and selected the correct words to complete sentences. These activities reflected Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) because students completed exercises to apply their knowledge. I used questioning, explanation, and guided practice to check their understanding.

I taught punctuation and capitalization through sentence correction and pair work. The example â€œLetâ€™s eat, Grandmaâ€ demonstrated how punctuation affects meaning. Students worked together to punctuate sentences and correct a paragraph. This pair-work activity reflected Vygotskyâ€™s Sociocultural Theory, as students learned through collaboration and interaction with their peers.

To develop spontaneous speaking, I organised the â€œPrompt Sparkâ€ activity. Students selected prompts, prepared for 30 seconds, and delivered a two-minute speech. I used a timer and provided constructive feedback. I also taught presentation skills, including organisation, visual aids, eye contact, time management, and managing nervousness. Students prepared presentations on corruption in Pakistan, artificial intelligence, and the effects of copy culture on education. They applied the presentation framework taught in the previous lesson, used icebreakers, organised their content, and responded to spontaneous questions. This reflected Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), as students practised expressing their ideas clearly and communicating with an audience. It also followed a learner-centred approach because students prepared and delivered their own presentations. Questioning and discussion supported Vygotskyâ€™s Sociocultural Theory through interaction and the exchange of ideas. Approximately 90% of the students understood and applied the presentation skills effectively.

In the narration lesson, I focused on transforming assertive or declarative sentences from direct to indirect speech. I explained the grammatical rules and then guided students through practice activities. This reflected the deductive approach, as I explained the rules before asking students to apply them. Approximately 90% of the students understood and correctly applied the rules of narration.

For letter writing, I explained the components of formal and informal letters and guided students in writing an inquiry letter about office supplies. This activity reflected Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT)

because students used their knowledge to complete a meaningful writing task. Approximately 85% of the students demonstrated a good understanding of letter writing.

Throughout these lessons, I used teaching techniques such as explanation, modelling, questioning, guided practice, pair work, worksheets, visual aids, oral discussion, and constructive feedback. I also used multiple-choice questions and written exercises to assess studentsâ€™ understanding and identify areas requiring further explanation.

4. Learning Outcomes and Skills

The internship strengthened my lesson planning, communication, classroom management, questioning, and assessment skills. Teaching a large co-educational class taught me to organise lesson content, provide clear instructions, manage classroom activities, and monitor students' progress. I also learned to identify learning difficulties and adjust my explanations when additional support was necessary.

Most importantly, I developed a clearer understanding of how Applied Linguistics theories can guide teaching decisions. I learned to combine theoretical principles with practical activities, encourage hesitant students, and provide constructive feedback. The experience also improved my ability to reflect on my teaching and identify areas for professional development.

5. Challenges Faced

Teaching a large co-educational class presented challenges related to student confidence, participation, and time management. Some students, particularly girls, were hesitant to speak in front of their classmates, while some boys also showed reluctance. Initially, some students seemed unfamiliar with applying theoretical concepts through practical activities.

To address these challenges, I began with simple questions and connected new lessons with previously taught material. Pair work and short practice activities allowed students to prepare before speaking publicly. I encouraged participation without excessive fear of mistakes and provided constructive feedback. Time management was another challenge, especially when lessons involved explanations, activities, and assessments. Gradually, I improved my planning by prioritising lesson objectives, clarifying instructions, and allocating time more effectively.

6. Conclusion

My internship at Government College for Information Technology was a valuable stage in my academic and professional development. It enabled me to apply the knowledge gained through Applied Linguistics, improve my teaching skills, and understand the challenges of working with a large co-educational class. The experience reinforced the importance of connecting theory with practice, encouraging student participation, and adapting teaching methods to learners' needs.

I recommend establishing an English Speaking Club with a weekly one-hour session to provide students with a supportive environment for practising speaking, exchanging ideas, and building confidence. Students should receive adequate preparation before public-speaking tasks, while regular co-curricular activities should complement textbook teaching to promote communication, creativity, and teamwork.

Professional development opportunities, varied teaching methodologies, and practical course materials can further strengthen teaching quality. Overall, the internship increased my confidence and strengthened my commitment to becoming an English lecturer. It taught me that effective teaching requires subject knowledge, careful planning, practical application, and a supportive approach to students' learning.